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Date: 12 Nov 2026

21LEM202T — Unit 1, Session 8, SLO 1

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — The Namaste Check: For each feeling behind the same Namaste, mark whether it is naturally acceptable and what it leads to within you.

Feeling behind the gesture	Naturally acceptable? (Yes/No)	Leads to (harmony/happiness or disharmony/unhappiness)
Feeling of relationship / respect	**Yes**	**harmony/happiness**
Feeling of opposition / disrespect	**No**	**disharmony/unhappiness**

Activity 2 — Relationship or Opposition?: Check within yourself: is your natural acceptance to live in relationship (harmony) with others, or in opposition? Do you feel happy living in opposition?

My natural acceptance is to live in relationship (harmony) with others. I do not feel happy living in opposition; opposition leads to disharmony and unhappiness within me.

Activity 3 — Three Kinds of Acceptance

Give one example of each from your own life.

Type	Meaning	My example
Natural acceptance	Innate, invariant, universal	**I naturally accept that all human beings want to be happy and respected.**
Acceptance	What I assume in a situation	**I accepted that my friend was upset with me because of a misunderstanding, even though I wasn't sure.**
Forced acceptance	What I am forced to abide by	**I was forced to accept the new school dress code even though I disagreed with it.**

Activity 4 — Natural Acceptance vs Liking

Write what you LIKE and the deeper thing you NATURALLY ACCEPT.

Example	I like...	I naturally accept...
Food (tasty vs nurturing)	**I like spicy and sweet junk food.**	**I naturally accept that my body needs nutritious, balanced meals to stay healthy.**
Studying (to understand vs to cram for exam)	**I like to study only the night before an exam to get a good grade.**	**I naturally accept that true learning comes from understanding concepts deeply over time.**

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. What is natural acceptance, and how is it distinguished from liking or appeal? Give an example.

Natural acceptance is an innate, invariant, and universal acceptance that is true for all human beings, independent of time, culture, or personal preferences. It is distinguished from liking or appeal because liking is based on personal taste, conditioning, or momentary attraction, which can vary from person to person and change over time. For example, I may like eating junk food (liking), but I naturally accept that my body needs healthy food to function well (natural acceptance).

Q2. Using the Namaste example, explain how the same expression can be naturally acceptable or not, and what can and cannot be checked by natural acceptance.

The gesture of Namaste can be naturally acceptable when it is done with genuine respect and a feeling of honoring the other person, as it aligns with the innate human value of mutual respect. It can be not naturally acceptable when it is done mechanically, under compulsion, or with a feeling of superiority or insincerity, because then it contradicts the inner feeling. Natural acceptance can check the intention and feeling behind the expression — whether it is authentic and harmonious — but it cannot check the external form or social convention itself, as the same gesture can be used with different inner states.

Q3. Distinguish between natural acceptance, acceptance and forced acceptance.

Natural acceptance is innate, invariant, and universal — it is what we accept as true for all human beings at all times, such as the desire for happiness and respect. Acceptance is what we assume or agree to in a particular situation based on our understanding, circumstances, or conditioning, and it can change. Forced acceptance is what we are compelled to abide by due to external pressure, rules, or authority, even if we do not internally agree with it.